The numbers that matter most are the ones nobody shares. This course reveals them.

Using Carta's proprietary data on 40,000+ startups, we'll take a data-driven tour through the startup lifecycle —from co-founder equity splits to IPO—exposing the benchmarks founders won't share and the math investors won't explain.



Premise™

MERCEDES BENT

CO-FOUNDER, PREMISE VC ·
FORMER PARTNER, LIGHTSPEED VENTURE PARTNERS

Co-founded Premise in 2025 with former NEA partner Vanessa Larco — a pre-seed and seed fund writing $500K–$3M checks into AI-native technical founders. Before that, six years as a partner at Lightspeed investing at the early stage, and an early employee and GM at General Assembly, where she grew her division from $0 to $30M+ in two years. Stanford MBA and MA in Education; Harvard AB.



HOSTED BY LORENZO BARBERIS CANONICO,
PRESIDENT OF CASSANDRA LABS

03 SERIES A & THE INSTITUTIONAL TRANSITION

Series A is where governance gets real: you add board members, negotiate pro-rata rights, and face investors who expect a different level of rigor

01 The Series A bar, and how hard it is to clear

02 How long it takes to get there

03 Bridges on the way to the A

04 Is the A even worth it

DATE
Sept 16

TIME
4:30 – 6:30pm

LOCATION
MLK — Stephens Lounge

REGISTER & FULL SCHEDULE hilarious-droplet-6be.notion.site/Venture-Math